TOPIC 1 · THE NATIONAL REPORTING SYSTEM

8 minutes · 1930 · NCRP · I4C · Sanchar Saathi · banks, police, platforms, regulators, CERT-In

What is it?

India has a coordinated system for citizens to report cyber-crime. The **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** under the Ministry of Home Affairs runs the **1930 helpline** for financial cyber fraud and the **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)** for all cyber-crime complaints. Complaints reach the police of the relevant state, and financial-fraud reports reach banks and payment providers so they can try to hold money.



Figure 6.3 · India's citizen cyber-reporting system

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Channel	Use it for	Note
1930	Money lost to online fraud, especially within hours	Gives an acknowledgement; complete the NCRP complaint afterwards
cybercrime.gov.in	All cyber-crime complaints; tracking status	"Women/child related" complaints can be made without login; CSAM can be reported anonymously
Chakshu (sancharsaathi.gov.in)	Suspected fraud calls, SMS and WhatsApp messages with no money lost	Helps disconnect fraudulent numbers
CEIR (sancharsaathi.gov.in)	Blocking a lost or stolen phone	Also report to the police and the telecom provider
Know your mobile connections	Checking SIMs registered in your name	Report numbers you do not recognise
Cyber Dost (I4C)	Official awareness posts and alerts	Awareness only, not a complaint channel

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TOPIC 2 · THE REPORTING MAP

12 minutes · primary and parallel routes · twelve common situations · order of action

What is it?

Most incidents need **more than one route**. The **primary route** is the first call that stops harm; **parallel routes** handle the other parts of the case. Decide the order with three questions: Is anyone in danger? Is money moving? Is an account or SIM taken over?



Figure 6.4 · Which route first?

Situation	Primary route	Parallel routes
UPI / card / net-banking fraud	1930 and the bank, at once	NCRP complaint; written complaint to bank within 3 working days
SIM suddenly dead, then debits	Bank and 1930	Telecom provider; NCRP; email and app recovery
WhatsApp or social account taken over	In-app recovery; warn contacts	Platform report; NCRP; contacts who paid call 1930
Sextortion or morphed images	Safety; platform report; StopNCII / Take It Down	NCRP (women/child); police; 181 or 1098
Child in danger or sexual exploitation	112 / police; 1098	NCRP child section; POCSO reporting
Fake profile or impersonation	Platform impersonation report	NCRP; police if threats or fraud
Loan-app harassment	NCRP; police	Report the app to the store; RBI Sachet if unregistered lending
Investment or trading scam	1930 if money recently paid; NCRP	SEBI SCORES for registered intermediaries; RBI Sachet; police
Ransomware at a school, shop or office	IT lead or owner; isolate	CERT-In (organisation reports); NCRP; police
Lost or stolen phone	Telecom (block SIM); CEIR	Police report; change passwords from another device
Fraud call or SMS, no loss	Chakshu	Warn family; block number
Personal data misused by a company	Company's grievance officer	Data Protection Board under the DPDP Act after the grievance

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TOPIC 3 · FILING ON CYBERCRIME.GOV.IN

10 minutes · eight steps · what to keep ready · acknowledgement, FIR and Zero FIR

What is it?

A complaint on the portal is only as good as the information in it. Before starting, open the evidence register (Module 5) and the intake form (Module 4). The citizen logs in with their own mobile number and OTP. After submission, the portal gives an **acknowledgement number** by SMS and email: this is the key to tracking.

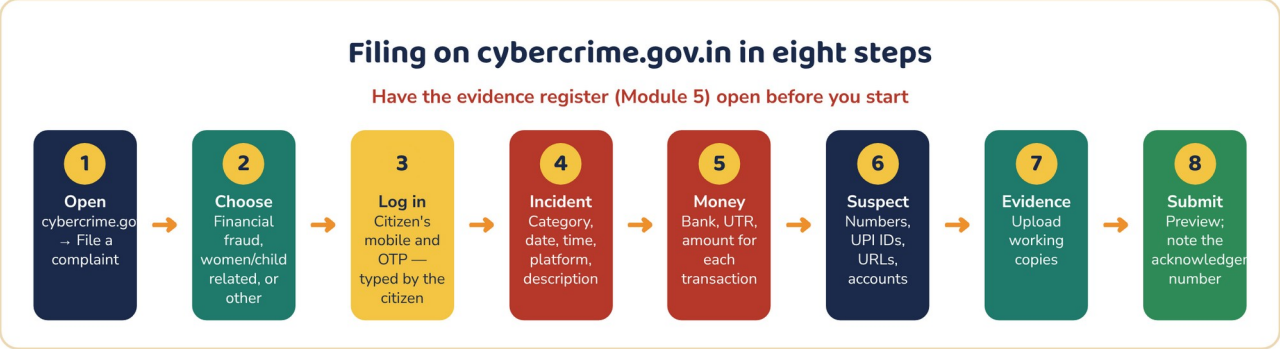


Figure 6.5 · Filing on cybercrime.gov.in in eight steps

Acknowledgement, FIR and Zero FIR

Know what the citizen has — and what comes next

Record	What it is	Who gives it	What to tell the citizen
NCRP acknowledgement	Proof that the complaint was received on the portal	Portal, by SMS and email	Keep it safe; it is the key to tracking. It is not an FIR
FIR	First Information Report of a cognisable offence; starts investigation	Police station with jurisdiction	Free copy is the citizen's right
Zero FIR / e-FIR	FIR registered at any police station, or information given electronically, then transferred (BNSS s.173)	Any police station	Ask for it if told "not our area"; sign an e-FIR within 3 days

Figure 6.6 · Acknowledgement, FIR and Zero FIR

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Keep ready before filing

- Citizen's mobile phone (for OTP) and, if asked, an identity document.
- For each transaction: bank, account or card (last four digits only), amount, date and time, UTR or transaction ID.
- Suspect identifiers: phone numbers, UPI IDs, account numbers, URLs, profile links, app names.
- Working copies of evidence from the register, with item IDs.

Ask yourself

- Is the citizen typing their own OTP and password?
- Does every transaction have its own UTR, amount and time?
- Have I noted the acknowledgement number and told the citizen where it is?

Stop	Save	Report
Do not submit duplicate complaints for the same incident.	Save the acknowledgement SMS and email; note it in the case file.	Track status on the portal; share the acknowledgement with the bank.

Remember

The acknowledgement is not an FIR — but it is the key to everything that follows.

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TOPIC 4 · WRITING AN ACTIONABLE COMPLAINT

8 minutes · seven elements · neutral language · time order · what to request

What is it?

An **actionable complaint** lets an officer act without calling the citizen back. It is **neutral** (facts, not feelings or accusations), **time-ordered**, and full of **identifiers**. It ends with what has been done and what is requested.

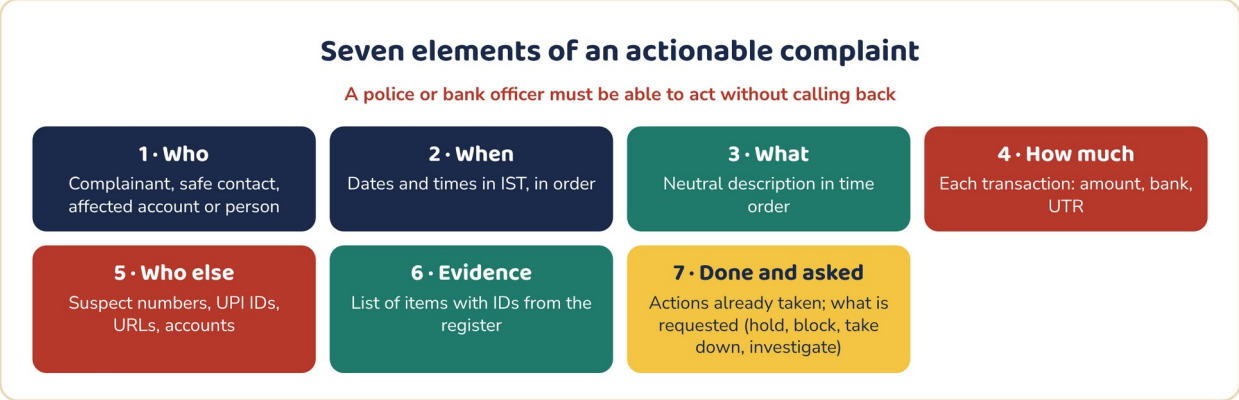


Figure 6.7 · Seven elements of an actionable complaint

Before (vague and emotional)	After (neutral and actionable)
"I was cheated by a fraud company. They took all my money. Please help urgently and catch them."	On 31 Oct 2026 at 18:20 IST I received a WhatsApp message from +91 9XXXX XX201 offering a part-time job. Between 19:05 and 21:40 IST I made three UPI payments from my XYZ Bank account: ₹2,000 (UTR 4301XXXX1101), ₹8,000 (UTR 4301XXXX1144) and ₹15,000 (UTR 4301XXXX1190) to UPI ID taskpay@XXX. When I asked to withdraw, I was asked for a ₹10,000 "tax". I called 1930 at 21:55 IST (ack. no. noted) and informed my bank at 22:05 IST. I request that the amounts be held and the matter investigated. Evidence: chat export and screenshots E-01 to E-06.

Remember

Facts, times, identifiers, actions taken, request. No adjectives needed.

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TOPIC 5 · ESCALATION AND FOLLOW-UP

10 minutes · tracking · bank and RBI Ombudsman · platform and GAC · police · CERT-In · follow-up log

What is it?

Follow-up means checking at agreed times whether each agency has acted, and recording what was said. **Escalation** means moving to the next level when a route does not respond in reasonable time — always with the earlier references and dates.

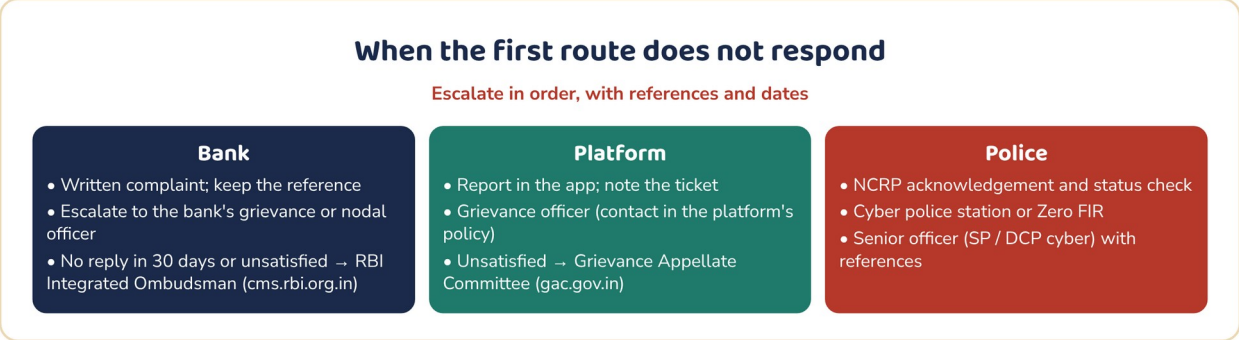


Figure 6.8 · When the first route does not respond

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Route	Rule a First Responder should know
Bank	Report unauthorised electronic transactions to the bank immediately, and in writing within 3 working days, to protect the customer's rights under RBI rules. If the bank does not resolve the complaint within 30 days, or the reply is unsatisfactory, the customer may complain under the RBI Integrated Ombudsman Scheme at cms.rbi.org.in
Platform	Under the IT Rules 2021, platforms have a grievance officer who must acknowledge complaints and resolve them within set timelines; intimate or morphed images must be acted on within 24 hours. Appeals go to the Grievance Appellate Committee (gac.gov.in)
Securities	Complain first to the broker or adviser; then on SEBI SCORES
Organisations	Service providers, intermediaries, data centres, companies and government bodies must report specified cyber incidents to CERT-In within 6 hours of noticing them (CERT-In directions, 2022). Citizens and small organisations can also report to CERT-In
Police	If a station refuses because of jurisdiction, ask for a Zero FIR; an e-FIR given electronically must be signed within three days (BNSS s.173)

Follow-up log: date	Agency and reference	What was said	Next check and owner

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TOPIC 6 · LEGAL QUICK REFERENCE AND HONEST EXPECTATIONS

12 minutes · IT Act · BNS · BNSS · BSA · DPDP · POCSO · rights of the citizen · what to promise and not promise

What is it?

A First Responder does not give legal advice, but should be able to explain, in a sentence, which laws protect the citizen and what rights they have. The new criminal laws — Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA) — replaced the IPC, CrPC and Evidence Act from 1 July 2024.

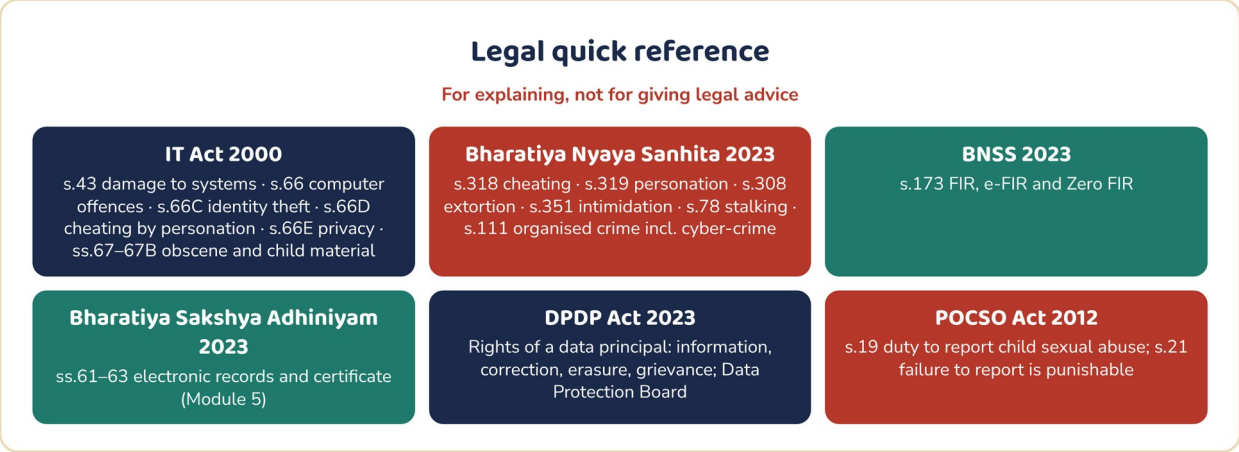


Figure 6.9 · Legal quick reference



Figure 6.10 · Honest expectations

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The citizen asks...	What a First Responder can say
"Will I get my money back?"	"Reporting fast gives the best chance that the bank can hold money still in the accounts. I cannot promise a refund or a date; the bank and police decide."
"The station says it is not their area."	"You can ask for a Zero FIR; it will be transferred to the right station."
"Can the company keep using my data?"	"Under the DPDP Act you can ask the company what data it holds, ask for correction or erasure, and complain to it; if unresolved, to the Data Protection Board."
"Is it a crime if he shares my photo?"	"Sharing private or morphed images without consent is an offence under the IT Act and the BNS. Let us report it and stop the spread."

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM MODULE 6

Takeaway	In one line
Danger, money, account	Decide the order of routes with three questions
Primary plus parallel	Most cases need more than one agency
Actionable complaint	Seven elements, neutral, time-ordered
Acknowledgement ≠ FIR	Track it; ask for a Zero FIR when needed
Escalate with references	Bank → RBI Ombudsman; platform → GAC; police → senior officer
Never promise outcomes	Explain who acts and what happens next

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